

Moderated Mediation of Opioid-Related Mortality

Jtt

February 2026

1 Methodological Framework

The following diagram synthesizes the moderating influence of Rurality (Z_1) and SES (Z_2) on the causal path between OUD (X) and Mortality (Y), mediated by ED Visits (M).

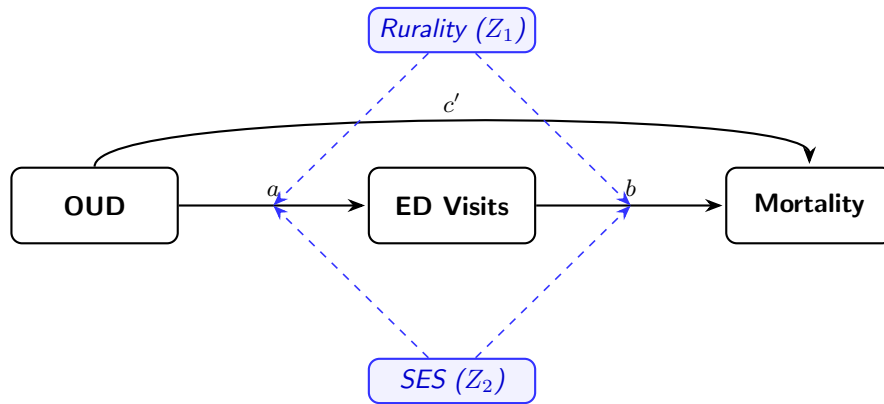


Figure 1: Conceptual path diagram of the moderated mediation model.